PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS REPORT

Project Title	Phishing Email Analysis
Organization	Future Interns
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Tools Used

Mx ToolBox	Google admin - Message Header	Manual Analysis

Email Sample 1 – Suspicious Adult Content Phishing Email

1. Basic Email Details

Field	Details
Subject	View this email only if you are an adult
Sender Name	Nerena Groen
Sender Email	contact@123gereedschap.nl
Return Path	mail@123gereedschap.nl
Sender IP	135.125.217.197
Link in Email	https://safecloud.link/51fdd860-8ce0-4cf6-bf44-e5b29e312bb7
Email Type	Suspicious / Phishing
Spam Confidence Level	9 (High)

2. Email Content

Subject: View this email only if you are an adult

Body:

WARNING: This website contains explicit images, videos, stories, and pictures.

You must be 18 years or older to view this content. If you are under 18 or if such content is prohibited in your region, you should leave this website immediately.

The website is well known from television and has a success rate above 90%.

Sign up for free directly using this link:

https://safecloud.link/51fdd860-8ce0-4cf6-bf44-e5b29e312bb7

This is a temporary offer, so take advantage of it before it expires.

3. Header Analysis – Using Google Admin Toolbox – Messageheader

Header Field	Result
SPF Authentication	Pass (IP Unknown)
DKIM Signature	None
DMARC	BestGuessPass
Sender IP Address	Not Clearly Identified
Reverse DNS	Not Available
Spam Confidence Level	Not Available

Analysis:
The email passes SPF authentication but the sending IP address is not clearly verified. The message is not signed with DKIM, which means the sender's domain cannot be cryptographically authenticated. DMARC shows a best guess pass, indicating that the domain policy may not be fully configured. Due to the absence of DKIM and incomplete sender verification, the email should be treated as suspicious and requires further investigation.

4. Phishing Indicators

(a) Sender Domain Inconsistency

The sender address is:

• contact@123gereedschap.nl

However, the hyperlink included in the message redirects users to a different domain:

• safecloud.link

This difference between the sender domain and the destination link is a common characteristic of phishing emails.

(b) Suspicious Hyperlink

The email contains the following external link:

• https://safecloud.link/51fdd860-8ce0-4cf6-bf44-e5b29e312bb7

Unknown or shortened domains are frequently used by attackers to redirect victims to malicious or deceptive websites.

(c) Social Engineering Techniques

The email uses adult content references to attract user curiosity and encourage them to click the link. This tactic is often used in phishing emails because users may click the link without carefully checking its legitimacy.

(d) Urgency-Based Messaging

The message encourages immediate action by stating that the offer is temporary. This tactic is commonly used in phishing campaigns to pressure recipients into clicking links quickly.

(e) High Spam Confidence Level

The email header indicates a Spam Confidence Level (SCL) of 9, which is classified as a high-risk spam or phishing email.

5. Risk Classification

Category	Result
Email Category	Spam / Phishing
Risk Level	High
Justification	Suspicious link, domain mismatch, social engineering tactics, and high spam confidence score

6. Explanation

This email attempts to persuade recipients to visit an external website by using curiosity-driven messaging related to adult content. The mismatch between the sender's domain and the embedded link suggests possible phishing activity. Additionally, the high spam confidence level assigned by the mail server indicates that the email is likely part of a spam or phishing campaign designed to redirect users to suspicious websites.

7. Prevention Guidelines

Recommended Practices

• Verify the sender's email address carefully before interacting with the message.
• Hover over links to inspect the actual destination URL before clicking.
• Report suspicious emails to the IT security team.

Actions to Avoid

• Avoid clicking links from unknown or suspicious emails.
• Do not provide personal or financial information through email links.
• Do not download attachments from untrusted sources.

Email Sample 2 – Binance Account Verification Phishing Email

1. Basic Email Details

Field	Details
Subject	[Binance] Immediate verification required
Sender Name	Binance
Sender Email	do-not-reply@ses.binance.com
Return Path	wpcloud@ilonasavola.com
Sender IP	84.34.166.151
Link in Email	https://zzdzw.com
Email Type	Suspicious / Phishing
Spam Confidence Level	5 (Medium–High)

2. Email Content

Subject: Immediate Verification Required

Body:

Dear phishing@pot,

Thank you for using Binance.

We were reviewing all account information and we noticed that your information has been expired. Your withdrawals are disabled until you update your informations.

Update your information using the link below:

https://zzdzw.com

Important Notice: If you don't update your information within 72 hours, your account will get disabled permanently.

Binance Team.

This is an automated message, please do not reply.

3. Header Analysis - Using Google Admin Toolbox – Messageheader

Header Field	**Result**
SPF Authentication	None
DKIM Signature	None
DMARC	Fail
Sender IP Address	HE1EUR01FT054.eop-EUR01.prod.protection.outlook.com
Reverse DNS	Not Available
Spam Confidence Level	Not Available

Analysis:

The email fails authentication checks. Both SPF and DKIM show “none,” meaning the sender’s identity cannot be verified and the email’s integrity is not protected. As a result, DMARC fails.

Although the From address claims to be from Binance, the Message-ID comes from a .dev staging domain, which is suspicious. The recipient address phishing@pot suggests the email was caught by a security filter. Due to the authentication failures and the mismatch between the sender and mail server, the email is likely a phishing attempt and should be blocked.

4. Phishing Indicators

(a) Sender Domain Inconsistency

The sender address appears to be:

• do-not-reply@ses.binance.com

However, the Return Path is:

• wpcloud@ilonasavola.com

This mismatch between domains suggests that the sender identity may be spoofed.

(b) Suspicious Hyperlink

The email contains the following link:

• https://zzdzw.com

This domain is unrelated to Binance's official domain (binance.com). Attackers often use unrelated domains to redirect victims to phishing websites.

(c) Social Engineering Techniques

The email informs the recipient that their account withdrawals are disabled due to expired information. This message is designed to create fear and encourage users to quickly update their information without verifying the legitimacy of the email.

(d) Urgency-Based Messaging

The email states that the account will be permanently disabled if the information is not updated within **72 hours**. This urgency tactic pressures users into clicking the link quickly.

(e) Authentication Failures

The email header shows:

- SPF: None
- DKIM: None
- DMARC: Fail

These failures indicate that the message cannot be verified as coming from the legitimate Binance domain.

5. Risk Classification

Category	Result
Email Category	Spam / Phishing
Risk Level	High
Justification	Suspicious link, sender mismatch, authentication failures, and urgency tactics

6. Explanation

This email attempts to impersonate Binance by claiming that the user's account information has expired. The message encourages the recipient to click on an external link to update their information. However, the link directs to a domain that is unrelated to Binance. Additionally, the mismatch between the sender and return path domains, combined with failed authentication checks, indicates that this email is likely part of a phishing attempt designed to steal user credentials.

7. Prevention Guidelines

Recommended Practices

• Verify the sender's email address carefully before interacting with the message.
• Hover over links to inspect the actual destination URL before clicking.
• Access sensitive accounts only through official websites.
• Report suspicious emails to the IT security team.

Actions to Avoid

• Avoid clicking links from unknown or suspicious emails.
• Do not provide personal or financial information through email links.
• Do not download attachments from untrusted sources.

Email Sample 3 – Promotional / Spam Phishing Email

1. Basic Email Details

Field	**Details**
Subject	Massive 400% Welcome Offer + 50 free spins awaits you when you open your account
Sender Name	FreeSpins4You
Sender Email	registration@and.co.uk
Return Path	return@1643937178.tendrum.me
Sender IP	96.126.118.136
Link in Email	http://laredouteshop.com
Email Type	Spam / Phishing
Spam Confidence Level	9 (High)

2. Email Content

Subject: Massive 400% Welcome Offer + 50 free spins awaits you when you open your account

Body:

The email promotes an online offer claiming that users will receive a 400% welcome bonus and 50 free spins when they open an account.

The message includes promotional content, news headlines, and embedded images designed to encourage users to click on external links. The email also contains a clickable image that redirects users to the following website:

http://laredouteshop.com

Additionally, the email contains an option to unsubscribe from the mailing list through another external link.

3. Header Analysis – Using Mx ToolBox

Header Field	Result
SPF Authentication	Fail
DKIM Signature	None
DMARC	Fail
Sender IP Address	96.126.118.136
Reverse DNS	pexinterest.com
Spam Confidence Level	9

Analysis:
The email fails SPF authentication because the sending IP address (96.126.118.136) is not authorized to send emails on behalf of the domain specified in the message header. The email is also not signed with DKIM, which means the sender's domain cannot be cryptographically verified. Additionally, the email fails DMARC validation, indicating that the message does not comply with the domain's authentication policies. These authentication failures strongly suggest that the email may be malicious or part of a spam or phishing campaign.

4. Phishing Indicators

(a) Sender Domain Inconsistency

The sender email address appears as:

• registration@and.co.uk

However, the Return Path domain used for sending the email is different:

• return@1643937178.tendrum.me

This mismatch indicates that the message may not originate from a legitimate or trusted domain.

(b) Suspicious Hyperlinks

The email contains external links such as:

• http://laredouteshop.com

These links redirect users to unrelated domains that are not associated with the sender's domain, which is a common tactic used in phishing and spam campaigns.

(c) Social Engineering Techniques

The email uses attractive promotional offers such as:

• 400% welcome bonus

- 50 free spins

These incentives are designed to attract users and encourage them to click the provided links without verifying the authenticity of the message.

(d) Bulk Email Distribution

The email is sent to undisclosed recipients, indicating that it was distributed as part of a bulk email campaign. Phishing and spam emails are often sent to large numbers of recipients in this manner.

(e) Embedded Tracking Elements

The email contains hidden tracking images and external content used to monitor whether the recipient opens the email or interacts with the links. This technique is commonly used in spam campaigns.

5. Risk Classification

Category	Result
Email Category	Spam / Phishing
Risk Level	High
Justification	SPF and DMARC failure, suspicious external links, domain mismatch, and bulk email distribution

6. Explanation

This email appears to be part of a spam or phishing campaign that promotes an unrealistic promotional offer to attract users. The sender attempts to lure recipients with a large bonus and free spins, encouraging them to click external links that lead to unknown websites. The authentication failures in

SPF and DMARC, combined with the mismatch between the sender and return path domains, strongly indicate that the email is not legitimate. Such emails may redirect users to malicious websites designed to collect personal information or distribute malware.

7. Prevention Guidelines

Recommended Practices

• Verify the sender's email address and domain before interacting with promotional emails.
• Avoid clicking on links from unknown or suspicious emails.
• Use spam filtering tools and report suspicious emails to the IT security team.

Actions to Avoid

• Do not click promotional links from unverified sources.
• Avoid entering personal or financial information on unknown websites.
• Do not interact with emails that promise unrealistic rewards or bonuses.

Email Sample 4 – MetaMask Account Alert Phishing Email

1. Basic Email Details

Field	Details
Subject	[## Metamask ##] You have a new update
Sender Name	MetaMask (MVS)
Sender Email	87357344@mymts.net
Return Path	87357344@mymts.net
Sender IP	140.238.151.68
Link in Email	https://www.ninafernandes.com.br/

Email Type	Phishing
Spam Confidence Level	1 (Low – Passed filtering but suspicious content)

2. Email Content

Subject: [## Metamask ##] You have a new update

Body:

MetaMask Support

This email claims that a new device has accessed the recipient's MetaMask account and that the account password has been changed.

Device: iPhone
Browser: Safari
Date and time: 04/09/2022

The email instructs the user to follow the prompts to regain access to their account. It also warns that existing credits may be blocked if the user does not update their information.

The message further states that the user must provide a 12-word recovery phrase to verify ownership of the MetaMask wallet.

The email includes a clickable link labeled "View Account", which redirects users to an external website:

https://www.ninafernandes.com.br/istreto.html

3. Header Analysis - Using Google Admin Toolbox – Messageheader

Header Field	**Result**
SPF Authentication	Pass

DKIM Signature	Pass
DMARC	Best Guess Pass
Sender IP Address	140.238.151.68
Reverse DNS	mail.mymts.net
Spam Confidence Level	1

Although SPF and DKIM checks passed, this does not necessarily guarantee that the email is legitimate. Attackers may use compromised or misconfigured mail servers to send phishing emails that still pass authentication checks.

4. Phishing Indicators

(a) Suspicious Sender Identity

The email claims to be from MetaMask, but the sender address is:

• 87357344@mymts.net

This domain is unrelated to MetaMask, indicating possible impersonation.

(b) Request for Sensitive Information

The message requests the 12-word recovery phrase of the MetaMask wallet.

This phrase is extremely sensitive and should never be shared through email. Legitimate services do not request recovery phrases through email communication.

(c) Suspicious External Link

The email contains a link directing users to:

• https://www.ninafernandes.com.br/istreto.html

This domain is unrelated to the official MetaMask website and may redirect users to a malicious phishing page designed to steal credentials.

(d) Account Security Threat Message

The email warns that account access may be blocked or credits disabled if the user does not act quickly. Such warnings create panic and pressure users to click the provided link immediately.

(e) Bulk Email Distribution

The email was sent to undisclosed recipients, indicating it was likely distributed to many users as part of a phishing campaign.

5. Risk Classification

Category	Result
Email Category	Phishing
Risk Level	High
Justification	Impersonation of MetaMask, request for recovery phrase, suspicious external link, and social engineering tactics

6. Explanation

This email attempts to impersonate the MetaMask cryptocurrency wallet service. It falsely claims that a new device accessed the user's account and that the password was changed. The attacker attempts to create urgency and trick users into clicking a malicious link and entering their recovery phrase.

Since the recovery phrase grants full access to a cryptocurrency wallet, sharing it would allow attackers to steal the user's funds. Despite passing some authentication checks, the domain mismatch and request for sensitive information clearly indicate that this email is a phishing attempt.

7. Prevention Guidelines

Recommended Practices

• Always verify the sender domain before responding to account alerts.
• Access cryptocurrency accounts only through the official website or mobile application.
• Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) for additional security.

Actions to Avoid

• Never share your 12-word recovery phrase or private keys with anyone.
• Do not click links in suspicious account alert emails.
• Avoid entering credentials on unknown or unverified websites.

Email Sample 5 – Fake Order Confirmation Phishing Email

1. Basic Email Details

Field	Details
Subject	OrderConfirmation:93345881
Sender Name	2U
Sender Email	makarifulislamkariful24599+NMwGO8qDiD8HKv6RyvtRa6ND11@gmail.com
Return Path	makarifulislamkariful24599@gmail.com
Sender IP	209.85.166.43

Link in Email	https://lnkd.in/eQNhqYKW
Email Type	Suspicious / Phishing
Spam Confidence Level	1 (Low – but suspicious behavior detected)

2. Email Content

Subject: OrderConfirmation:93345881

Body:

The email appears to be an order confirmation message sent from a Gmail account. The email contains an embedded image with clickable areas that redirect users to external links.

The message does not provide any clear order details such as:

o Product information

o Purchase date

o Payment method

o Order amount

Instead, the email contains an image with hyperlinks that redirect to the following URL:

https://lnkd.in/eQNhqYKW

The use of clickable images without clear textual information is a common technique used in phishing emails to hide malicious links.

3. Header Analysis – Using Mx ToolBox

Header Field	**Result**
SPF Authentication	Pass

DKIM Signature	Pass
DMARC	Not Available
Sender IP Address	Not Available
Reverse DNS	mail.mymts.net
Spam Confidence Level	Not Available

Analysis:
The email passes SPF and DKIM authentication, indicating that the sender is authorized and the message content was not altered during transmission. However, DMARC results are not available, so full domain alignment cannot be confirmed. The email was sent using PHPMailer, which is commonly used for sending emails but can also be misused in phishing campaigns. Therefore, the email content and links should be checked carefully to verify its legitimacy.

4. Phishing Indicators

(a) Suspicious Sender Address

The sender email address appears as:

• makarifulislamkariful24599+NMwGO8qDiD8HKv6RyvtRa6ND11@gmail.com

The long and unusual email format suggests that it may be an automatically generated or disposable email account used for sending spam.

(b) Lack of Order Information

A legitimate order confirmation email typically includes details such as:

• Order number
• Product description
• Payment details
• Billing or shipping address

However, this email does not provide any such information, making it suspicious.

(c) Embedded Image with Hidden Links

The email contains an image with clickable areas that redirect users to external links. This technique hides the actual link destination and encourages users to click without verifying the URL.

(d) Suspicious External Link

The email contains a link that redirects users to:

- https://lnkd.in/eQNhqYKW

Shortened links or redirect links are often used in phishing campaigns to conceal malicious destinations.

(e) Generic Subject Line

The subject line **"OrderConfirmation:93345881"** is vague and does not mention the company name or order details. Attackers commonly use generic subjects to trick recipients into opening the email out of curiosity or concern.

5. Risk Classification

Category	Result
Email Category	Phishing / Spam
Risk Level	Medium to High
Justification	Suspicious sender address, hidden hyperlinks in images, lack of order information.

6. Explanation

This email appears to be a phishing attempt disguised as an order confirmation message. The attacker uses a generic subject line and embeds hyperlinks inside an image to encourage recipients to click on the link. Since the email does not provide legitimate order details and uses a suspicious Gmail address, it is likely intended to redirect users to malicious websites. These websites may attempt to steal personal information, login credentials, or install malware on the victim's device.

7. Prevention Guidelines

Recommended Practices

- Verify order confirmation emails by checking your actual purchase history.
- Hover over links before clicking to inspect the real destination URL.
- Report suspicious emails to the IT security or email administration team.

Actions to Avoid

- Do not click links in unexpected order confirmation emails.
- Avoid downloading attachments from unknown senders.
- Do not provide personal or financial information through suspicious links.